

UNIT II - PARAGRAPH AND DIALOGUE WRITING

Communication Skills (English) — Course Code
311303

2.1 TYPES OF PARAGRAPHS

A paragraph is a group of related sentences that develop **one central idea**. A good paragraph has three parts: a **topic sentence** (introduces the idea), **supporting sentences** (develop it with details/examples), and a **concluding sentence** (wraps up the idea).

There are three types specified in your syllabus: **Technical, Descriptive, and Narrative**.

A. Technical Paragraph

A technical paragraph explains a process, object, machine, concept, or procedure in a **clear, factual, and objective** manner. It is commonly used in engineering/workplace writing.

Characteristics: - Uses precise, subject-specific vocabulary - Follows a logical step-by-step or descriptive structure - Avoids personal opinions, emotions, or flowery language - Often uses passive voice ("The switch is pressed" rather than "I press the switch") - May include specifications, dimensions, or technical terms

Structure: 1. **Topic sentence** - introduces what is being explained (object/process/concept) 2. **Body** - working principle, components, function, or steps in sequence 3. **Conclusion** - summarizes significance or application

Example: > A transformer is an electrical device used to increase or decrease voltage in an AC circuit. It consists of two coils — a primary and a secondary — wound around a common iron core. When alternating current flows through the primary coil, it creates a changing magnetic field, which induces a voltage in the secondary coil. The ratio of turns in the two coils determines whether the transformer steps up or steps down the voltage. Transformers are widely used in power transmission to reduce energy loss over long distances.

Tips for writing: - Start with a clear definition - Use connectors like *firstly, next, subsequently, finally* to show sequence - Keep sentences factual and concise

B. Descriptive Paragraph

A descriptive paragraph creates a **vivid picture** of a person, place, object, or scene using sensory details (sight, sound, smell, touch, taste). Unlike technical paragraphs, it can be subjective and expressive.

Characteristics: - Rich in adjectives and sensory imagery - Appeals to the reader's imagination - Organized spatially (top to bottom, near to far) or by importance - May use figurative language (similes, metaphors)

Structure: 1. **Topic sentence** - introduces the subject being described 2. **Body** - specific sensory details, arranged logically 3. **Conclusion** - overall impression or feeling

Example: > The old library stood at the corner of the street, its red-brick walls weathered by decades of monsoons. Tall wooden shelves lined every wall, filled with books whose pages smelled faintly of dust and old paper. Sunlight filtered through the tall arched windows, casting golden patterns across the worn wooden floor. The silence inside was broken only by the occasional rustle of turning pages. It felt like stepping into a world where time moved slower.

Tips for writing: - Use specific, concrete details instead of vague ones ("a red convertible" instead of "a car") - Engage multiple senses, not just sight - Arrange details in a logical order (spatial or by importance)

C. Narrative Paragraph

A narrative paragraph **tells a story or recounts an event**, real or imagined, with a clear beginning, middle, and end. It focuses on characters, setting, sequence of events, and often a conflict or turning point.

Characteristics: - Written in chronological order (uses time-order transitions: *first, then, after that, finally*) - Often uses past tense - Includes characters, setting, and plot - May include dialogue to make it engaging

Structure: 1. **Opening** - sets the scene (who, what, when, where) 2. **Body** - sequence of events, building toward a climax 3. **Conclusion** - resolution or outcome, sometimes a lesson learned

Example: > Last summer, I visited my grandmother's village for the first time. As soon as I arrived, the smell of fresh mangoes and the sound of cattle bells greeted me. On the second day, my cousins took me fishing in the nearby river. We waited patiently for hours, and just as I was about to give up, I felt a strong tug on my line. After a brief struggle, I pulled out the biggest fish I had ever caught. That evening, we cooked it together over an open fire, and I realized that some of life's best memories are the simplest ones.

Tips for writing: - Use time-connectors to maintain flow - Include specific details (dialogue, emotions) to make it engaging - End with a resolution, reflection, or takeaway

Quick Comparison Table

Feature	Technical	Descriptive	Narrative
Purpose	Explain a process/object	Create a picture	Tell a story
Tone	Objective, factual	Subjective, vivid	Personal, chronological
Language	Precise, technical terms	Sensory, figurative	Sequential, engaging
	Step-by-	Spatial/order of	Chronological

Structure	step/logical	importance	(time order)
Example topic	How a transformer works	Describing a library	An event during a village visit

2.2 DIALOGUE WRITING

A dialogue is a **written conversation between two or more people**. It tests the ability to use natural, contextually appropriate spoken English in written form. Good dialogue writing follows a three-part structure: **Greetings, Development, and Closing Sentence**.

i. Greetings (Opening)

The opening establishes the relationship between speakers and sets the context/purpose of the conversation.

Common greeting expressions: - Formal: *"Good morning, Sir/Madam. How may I help you?"* - Informal: *"Hi Raj! How's it going?"* - Professional: *"Good afternoon. Thank you for taking the time to meet me."*

Points to keep in mind: - Match the greeting to the **relationship** between speakers (formal for strangers/superiors, informal for friends/peers) - Include names or titles where appropriate (Mr., Dr., Sir) - The greeting should naturally lead into the topic of conversation

ii. Development (Body)

This is the main exchange of ideas — questions, answers, opinions, or information relevant to the situation. It should sound natural and flow logically.

Points to keep in mind: - Keep sentences short and conversational (avoid long, essay-like sentences) - Use natural spoken expressions: *"I see," "That makes sense," "Really?," "I'm not sure about that"* - Maintain a logical back-and-forth — each response should relate to the previous line - Use appropriate punctuation (quotation marks if written in narrative form, or speaker labels if written in script form) - Stay relevant to the situation/topic given

Example (script format): > **Amit:** I heard you're planning to specialize in robotics next semester. > **Priya:** Yes, I've always been fascinated by automation. What about you? > **Amit:** I'm still deciding between AI and electronics. Any advice? > **Priya:** Well, it depends on what excites you more — I'd suggest attending a few guest lectures before deciding.

iii. Closing Sentence (Ending)

The conversation should end naturally, not abruptly. The closing should reflect the tone of the interaction — polite, appreciative, or simply casual.

Common closing expressions: - Formal: *"Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you."* - Informal: *"Alright, catch you later!"* - Professional: *"It was great discussing this with you. Let's connect again soon."*

Points to keep in mind: - Avoid ending too suddenly — a proper sign-off feels complete - Match the closing tone to the greeting (don't open formally and close casually)

Full Dialogue Example (Situational)

Situation: A student asking a librarian for help finding a book

Student: Good afternoon, Ma'am. Could you help me find a book on thermodynamics? **Librarian:** Good afternoon! Of course. Do you have the author's name or the exact title? **Student:** I'm not sure of the title, but I need it for my mechanical engineering course. **Librarian:** No problem, let me check the catalog... Yes, we have "Engineering Thermodynamics" by P.K. Nag. It's in the Science section, second shelf from the left. **Student:** That's great, thank you so much for your help. **Librarian:** You're welcome! Let me know if you need anything else.

Key Tips for Effective Dialogue Writing

1. **Be natural** – write the way people actually speak, not like formal essays
 2. **Stay in character** – tone/vocabulary should match age, profession, and relationship of speakers
 3. **Keep it relevant** – every line should move the conversation forward or reveal something about the situation
 4. **Use correct punctuation** – commas, question marks, quotation marks as per the format required
 5. **Maintain logical flow** – responses should directly connect to the previous statement
 6. **End appropriately** – don't just stop; close the exchange naturally
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Quick Revision Summary

Topic	Core Idea	Skill Developed
Technical Paragraph	Objective explanation of process/object	Precise technical writing
Descriptive Paragraph	Sensory, vivid depiction	Imaginative & expressive writing
Narrative Paragraph	Chronological storytelling	Sequencing & engaging narration
Dialogue Writing	Structured conversation (Greeting-Development-Closing)	Natural spoken/written communication

Aligned to CO2: "Compose paragraphs and dialogues on given situations" and TLOs 2.1-2.2 as per MSBTE syllabus.